

DIRECTIONS *for questions 1 to 3:* The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **three** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Psychology has come to take on the rhetoric of personal enlightenment in its therapeutic practices and thus attempts to serve as a means of salvation. This is apparent in the self-help literature. The field of psychology gained in popularity by drawing on popular metaphors that shaped the human niche in an industrial landscape. In particular, psychology emphasised society's pressure to achieve efficiency through purpose, integration and productivity. Identity and autonomy as the key characteristics of personhood came together to perpetuate capitalism through extending the notion of exchange value over all relations. Mythology was traditionally the expression of an enchanted world, and now psychology is an attempt to fill the disenchanted space with a rich characterisation of interiority.

The mythology of psychology satisfies the affective and cognitive needs of belief. For reflective belief, it offers explanation and a path to salvation through causal-predictive principles and origin stories. For non-reflective belief, myth is enacted and entrained in a set of rituals. For example, one can believe that personality is caused by the chemical balance (or imbalance) of neurotransmitters, and one can enact this by the ritual of taking medication. Together, mythology and its practices in ritual provide the platform for creating meaning through making commitments in the act of belief. It does so by expressing, enhancing and codifying belief in a way that enforces morality and vouches for shared social activities. Myth enforces belief by enlivening our notions of fate and destiny, thus providing symbols and expressive ways to cope with the hazards of life. Meaning-seeking creatures need stories to deal with the unknown and provide guidance as to where we came from and where we're going. Mythology is that constant byproduct of living faith that triggers creativity in acts of interpretation and imagination. Myths are therefore an early solution for the tragic facts of life that are beyond the ken of practical, logical, scientific thought.

Mythological schemes – including psychology – provide stories about the origins of mortality, sexuality, society, rules and work. They offer a motivation for why things are the way they are. Our shared world is maintained by the practice of rites, of rituals... By providing explanatory tenets, psychology is thus a means of enabling humans to sustain their practices of personhood and materialism such that we can face the world with greater confidence and increased energy...

Q1. It cannot be inferred from the second paragraph that:

- ☐ a) we create stories to make sense of the unknown.
- ☐ b) morality enables our commitment to shared social activities.
- ☐ c) mythology provides us with a sense of purpose and identity.
- ☐ d) not everything in life can be explained through science and logic.

Q2. What the author means from 'This is apparent in the self-help literature' (first para) is that:

- ☐ a) psychology is society's way of pressuring humans into achieving efficiency.
- ☐ b) psychology provides identity and autonomy to disenchanting individuals.
- ☐ c) the popularity of psychology stems from offering individuals a renewed sense of purpose.
- ☐ d) pushing humans to transcend into something greater has become an objective of psychology.

Q3. The difference between reflective and non-reflective beliefs is that:

- ☐ a) The former is satisfied by explanations while the latter is satisfied by physical action.
- ☐ b) The former is introspective while the latter is emotional.
- ☐ c) The former is based in theory while the latter is based in practices.
- ☐ d) The former is about receiving answers, while the latter is about following a codified process.

DIRECTIONS *for questions 4 to 8:* The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **five** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Many researchers, especially those outside of anthropology in fields such as cognitive science, psychology, or linguistics, have used the term “Sapir–Whorf Hypothesis” as shorthand for a simplistic and easily dismissible “strong” version of Sapir and Whorf’s beliefs, which purportedly (and mistakenly) states that language determines thought. In this view, the particular language you speak rigidly structures your thought in an inescapable manner. The causal arrow for this obviously wrong “strong” version of the so-called Sapir–Whorf Hypothesis runs in just one direction between language and thought, and culture is nowhere in the picture.

While Boas, Sapir, and Whorf all wrote about language’s relationship to thought and culture, and while they were clearly influenced by one another, what has come to be called the “Sapir–Whorf Hypothesis” is a misnomer in several respects. First, Sapir and Whorf never co-authored anything. Whorf was deeply influenced by his professor Sapir, but the two scholars’ views on language, thought, and culture diverged significantly. Second, although some highly respected scholars have taken on the task of formulating specific, empirically testable hypotheses stemming from the insights of Boas, Sapir, and Whorf, these scholars themselves never framed their research using these terms from the realm of science...

A more accurate depiction of the view of many linguistic anthropologists is one in which language, thought, and culture all influence one another. In this model, the particular language you speak may predispose you to think a certain way or to engage in certain cultural practices or beliefs, but this relationship is by no means a rigidly deterministic one, nor is it unidirectional. Instead, language, thought, and culture are all viewed as influencing one another in a flexible, mutually constitutive way. The relative strengths of the relationships remain unspecified and perhaps unknowable. It is possible that the relative strength of the influence of language on thought and culture is more in some cases than in others, making it an empirical question to investigate, but it is also possible that the relative strength of the influence of these three overlapping entities could never be specified with any precision. Some linguistic anthropologists (e.g., Hill and Mannheim 1992) maintain that this sort of multidirectional relationship is best conceived of as an axiom – an assumption that informs all research on language in social contexts – rather than as an empirically testable hypothesis with dependent and independent variables.

Supporters of the axiom view argue that there is no clear-cut way to distinguish that which is linguistic from that which is non-linguistic. Everything is linguistically mediated, they contend, so it is impossible to separate something called “language” from the two allegedly non-linguistic entities called “thought” and “culture.” As with other working assumptions, Hill and Mannheim assert, treating this relationship as axiomatic means that it is not falsifiable but instead is to be judged only “on the basis of the extent to which it leads to productive questions about talk and social action”. Researchers who endorse this approach to the relationship of language to thought and culture strongly maintain that the social world is largely constituted by, and knowable through, language, much as Sapir famously argued more than 80 years ago.

Q4. Which of the following best states the ‘assumption’ in ‘an assumption that informs all research on language in social contexts’ in the context of the passage?

- ☐ a) Language, thought and culture are interchangeable in social contexts.
- ☐ b) Thought and culture cannot be expressed without language.
- ☐ c) Language, thought and culture are intertwined in a non-tangible way.
- ☐ d) The multidirectional relationship between culture, thought and language can be clearly defined.

Q5. Which of the following, if proven to be false, is most compatible with the 'strong' version of the so-called Sapir-Whorf hypothesis mentioned in the first para?

- ☐ a) Our thoughts are based on the language we have been taught to speak.
- ☐ b) Thoughts are nothing but our mind's response to the language we speak and hear.
- ☐ c) Human thought doesn't need a language to be expressed.
- ☐ d) Our thoughts are fundamentally influenced by factors unrelated to language.

Q6. The author dubs the Sapir-Whorf hypothesis a 'misnomer' primarily because:

- ☐ a) the hypothesis was framed by respected scholars using Sapir and Whorf's insights.
- ☐ b) the hypothesis is not empirically testable in the realms of science.
- ☐ c) Sapir, Whorf and Boas all worked individually even though they were all influenced by each other.
- ☐ d) there is no hypothesis particularly framed by Sapir and Whorf.

Q7. Which of the following, if true, weakens the contention of the supporters of the axiom view?

- ☐ a) Thought and culture take shape only through language.
- ☐ b) Thought and culture can be expressed through paintings.
- ☐ c) Thought and culture can be defined only in terms of expressions of language.
- ☐ d) Thought and culture are born almost at the same time as language.

Q8. Which of the following studies is the author most likely to approve of?

- ☐ a) A study that analyses how the influence of language on thought and culture varies from one language to another
- ☐ b) A study that analyses the impact of the multidirectional relationship between language, thought and culture on social contexts
- ☐ c) A study that analyses whether language is influenced by thought or thought is influenced by language
- ☐ d) A study that analyses whether culture and language influence each other equally or one has more influence on the other

DIRECTIONS *for questions 9 to 11:* The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **three** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The demonstration of the importance of the cultural element has led management theorists to focus on theories developed by anthropologists, which have led them to a deeper understanding of the way that these cultures function and to develop models with practical applications for business management. Three models have been widely used in recent decades for teaching culture in business management...

In the iceberg theory Hall proposed a series of external (visible and objective) and internal (invisible and unconscious) elements. In turn, the internal elements are composed of two levels; one is formal, made up of elements such as rituals and customs that can be taught and learnt, and the other is informal, consisting of elements that are acquired without being consciously aware of them, where the concepts of time and space and individualism and collectivism stand out.

In the onion skin theory, Hofstede described culture as a series of layers, some of which are more visible than others, divided into two main sections; the least visible part, the heart of a culture, consists of its values, whilst the most visible part consists of its practices, which in turn can be divided into three parts: symbols, heroes and rituals.

In the layers of culture theory, Trompenaars distinguished three levels, ranging from the most to the least explicit. The most explicit level is made up of artefacts and products (which include institutions and laws, among others). The second level is formed by norms and values (norms of social behaviour), and the third, and least explicit level, are the basic assumptions about life, which are almost inaccessible from outside; they are acquired unconsciously and reflect the forms of behaviour that had been crucial to the survival of the group at a specific moment in time.

The interesting thing that the three models have in common is that they define culture in levels, some of which are external and some of which are internal, some visible from outside and others that cannot be recognized from outside. Also, all three models have in common the theory that the most profound base of a culture is made up of a series of unconscious elements, which form what at one definite time was the group response to a concrete problem that implied the survival or otherwise of the group. These responses conditioned typologies of behavior in relation to time or other people, which are reflected in the distinct dimensions of culture that can be observed today.

Q9. Which of the following groupings is inconsistent with the culture models discussed in the passage?

- ☐ a) Layers of culture – Trompenaars – Three levels of explicitness
- ☐ b) Iceberg – Formal customs -- Informal internal elements
- ☐ c) Onion skin – Less visible heart of the culture – More visible values and rituals
- ☐ d) Layers of culture – Norms of social behaviour – Unconsciously acquired forms of behaviour

Q10. Which of the following will be a logical follow-up question to the author of the passage?

- ☐ a) Is it possible to understand a culture's basic assumptions through close inspection?
- ☐ b) Can the culture of the group influence individuals' mindsets?
- ☐ c) Can individuals differ in their values from the common values of their culture?
- ☐ d) Is it possible to analyse why a culture has the dimensions that it does?

Q11. It cannot be inferred from the last para of the passage that:

- ☐ a) The experience of survival is embedded into the intrinsic culture of any group.
- ☐ b) Every model to explain culture acknowledges its layered structure.
- ☐ c) Behaviours of a community are influenced subconsciously by intrinsic elements of its culture.
- ☐ d) Not all the intrinsic elements of a culture can be fully understood.

DIRECTIONS for questions 12 to 16: The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **five** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

At a loose and almost casual level, theory is simply an orientation, framework, technique, or approach. Theory, in the more formal meanings of the term, has the following three meanings. First, in the natural and physical sciences, theory means a rigorous testing of predictive theorems or hypotheses using observable and comparable data. Theory in the natural or physical sciences can claim considerable accuracy in representing reality because the classification of order in the physical world is advanced, as are capacities to recognize and measure natural phenomena. In the social world, of which public administration is a part, the problems of recognizing patterns, designing categories, and measuring and comparing phenomena are much greater. Therefore, the aims of theory in public administration are different (and, some would say, lower).

Second, theory in the social sciences and in public administration means the ordering of factual material (history, events, cases, stories, measures of opinion, observation) to present evidence through definitions, concepts, and metaphors that promote understanding. To be sure, this understanding is subjective, because it was constructed by the theorist. This theory is based on the rigorous and intuitive observation of social behavior, organizational behavior, institutional dynamics, political systems and behavior, patterns of communication, and culture. Most of this action is not formally and explicitly acknowledged as driven by a particular theory. Public administration decisions and action are, nevertheless, based on fundamental assumptions about social behavior, patterns of human cooperation, incentives for action, and the like. Because of this, one of the primary tasks of theory in public administration is to make explicit and describe the assumptions that guide action and to develop the categories, concepts, definitions, and metaphors that foster an understanding of those assumptions.

Third, in public administration the meaning of theory is normative – theories of what ought to be. These theories form the bridges among public administration, political science, and philosophy. Dwight Waldo taught us that all theories of public administration are also theories of politics. Public administration practice is a busy and untidy world in which costs and benefits, all normatively based in nature and effort, are allocated among citizens through the authority of the state. Theories of public administration guide the authoritative allocation of public goods. Once again, the task of the theorist is often to discover theory that accounts for or describes observable regularities in behavior and to evaluate the normative implications of such behavior...

Furthermore, theory in public administration can differ depending on whether the subject is generally organizational, operational, managerial, or generally policy-specific. Finally, in public administration there is a special test of theory – how useful is it? Because of this test, the degree of measuring rigor and precision and the level of elaboration in a theory may be less important than the question of usefulness. Good or useful theory presumes to organize and classify data in such a way as to screen facts and then focus on only the most important. The test of a theory's usefulness is often its criteria in selecting and classifying facts, and if these are accurate, the theory will enhance understanding, guide research, and powerfully describe, explain, and predict.

Q12. Which of the following is not one of the three formal meanings of 'theory' as mentioned in the passage?

- ☐ a) It is a rigorously tested hypothesis that represents the physical reality accurately when data can be observed reliably.
- ☐ b) It is a guideline that can be proven to be useful based on the quality of data that it churns out.
- ☐ c) It is a collation of factual material to generate based on subjective parameters guiding the social sciences.
- ☐ d) It is a general representation of things as they should be in the political and public administration domain that guide authoritative action.

Q13. Public administration theories differ from scientific theories in all of the following ways EXCEPT:

- ☐ a) The former is not as accurate as the latter.
- ☐ b) The latter has higher quality of representative data at its disposal.
- ☐ c) The former deals with less tangible phenomena than the latter.
- ☐ d) The latter involves a greater number of provable theorems than the former.

Q14. The author calls the understanding promoted by definitions, concepts and metaphors (second para) subjective based on the assumption that:

- ☐ a) The rigor and facts observed will vary from one theorist to another.
- ☐ b) The theory will vary from one theorist to another.
- ☐ c) No specific theory goes beyond intuition and observation.
- ☐ d) Theories of public administration are based on fundamental assumptions.

Q15. All theories of public administration are also theories of politics because:

- ☐ a) Theories form the bridge between public administration and political science.
- ☐ b) Theories of public administration guide the state in dispensing public goods.
- ☐ c) The authoritative allocation of public goods is observed by the public administration theorist.
- ☐ d) The theorist has to understand and evaluate how the state allocates public goods.

Q16. A theory of public administration can enhance understanding and guide research if:

- ☐ a) it applies accurate criteria to sort through facts and pick the most important ones.
- ☐ b) it describes, explains, and predicts correctly based on important facts.
- ☐ c) it can organize and classify data based on its usefulness.
- ☐ d) its usefulness can be factually proven.

Q17. DIRECTIONS *for questions 17 and 18:* Read the following paragraph and answer the questions that follow.

Language changes us into beings that can express our inner brain states – our thoughts and feelings – as well as our past and our anticipated future brain states. Language can also fool us: its centrality to our behaviour and the close relationship between it and conscious brain states does not mean that language can provide a perfect read-out of the underlying brain states that generate it.

If the statements above are true, which of the following must also be true?

- ☐ a) Sub-conscious brain states may generate a part of our language.
- ☐ b) We may not accurately represent our inner brain states with language.
- ☐ c) Language always falls short of expressing our thoughts and feelings.
- ☐ d) We are not aware of our inner brain states.

Q18. DIRECTIONS *for questions 17 and 18:* Read the following paragraph and answer the questions that follow.

For Bitcoin's advocates, labelling Bitcoin as a speculative bubble is the ultimate insult. Bitcoin's supporters often point out that public support for Bitcoin is not fundamentally different from public support for many other things. For example, gold has held tremendous value in the public mind for thousands of years, but the public could just as well have accorded it little value if people had started using something else for money. People value gold primarily because they perceive that other people value gold.

Which of the following, if true, does most to justify the argument of the Bitcoin's advocates?

- ☐ a) People don't really know whether a sizeable number of people value gold.
- ☐ b) A person's valuation of gold correlates with that of others in a similar economic situation.
- ☐ c) People value gold because its accessibility is closely monitored and controlled.
- ☐ d) People purchase gold because it accords them with a higher social status.

Q19. DIRECTIONS *for question 19:* The sentences given in the question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a number. Decide on the proper order for the four sentences and key in the sequence of four numbers as your answer, in the input box given below the question.

1. It is this technique that allows cyclists to capitalize on the turbulent low-pressure zones left by the cyclist riding immediately ahead of them.

2. The low pressure behind the leading cyclist will help pull the following cyclist forward, while the vortices produced by the lead cyclist's wake will also swirl around the following cyclist and push him forward.

3. So significant is the effect of drafting that cyclists who are riding in a group can save up to 40 percent in energy expenditure over a cyclist who is riding solo.

4. When the cyclists are on their road bikes racing in a peloton, they take advantage of the aero modification as old as cycling itself – drafting.

Q20. DIRECTIONS *for question 20:* There is a sentence that is missing in the paragraph below. Look at the paragraph and decide in which blank (option 1, 2, 3, or 4) the following sentence would best fit.

Sentence: There must have been a moment when Oppenheimer’s advertising team were scratching their heads.

Paragraph: _____(1)_____. It’s difficult to compete with the happy buzz whipped up by the idea of Margot Robbie and Ryan Gosling, in Barbie, running around a life-size Barbieland with half of the biggest names in Hollywood, to a backing track that includes numbers from Ice Spice and Dua Lipa. Particularly when the film you’re trying to sell is about the first nuclear bomb. _____(2)_____. But the internet has found the juxtaposition between the two films to be a perfect balance. Barbie is ying, Oppenheimer is yang. Barbie is you on payday, Oppenheimer is you one week later. Barbie is how you feel in the morning before work, Oppenheimer is how you feel after a day at work. And so on. _____(3)_____. The colours – Barbie’s bright pink and Oppenheimer’s many greys – make the comparisons all the more stark, and hilarious. _____(4)_____.

- ☐ a) Option 1
- ☐ b) Option 2
- ☐ c) Option 3
- ☐ d) Option 4

Q21. DIRECTIONS *for question 21:* Read the following paragraph and answer the question that follows.

If China becomes an economic powerhouse, it will almost certainly translate its economic might into military might and make a run at dominating Northeast Asia. Whether China is democratic and deeply enmeshed in the global economy or autocratic and autarkic will have little effect on its behavior, because democracies care about security as much as nondemocracies do, and hegemony is the best way for any state to guarantee its own survival. Of course, neither its neighbors nor the United States would stand idly by while China gained increasing increments of power. Instead, they would seek to contain China, probably by trying to form a balancing coalition. In short, China and the United States are destined to be adversaries as China's power grows.

Which of the following is an assumption on which the argument depends?

- ☐ a) China will eventually use its economic might to dominate the United States militarily.
- ☐ b) The United States currently shares friendly terms with China's neighbours.
- ☐ c) China's hegemony will be opposed by its Northeast Asian neighbors.
- ☐ d) The United States is threatened by Chinese hegemony.

Q22. DIRECTIONS *for questions 22 and 23:* The sentences given in the question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a number. Decide on the proper order for the four sentences and key in the sequence of four numbers as your answer, in the input box given below the question.

1. And it's obvious the writers and producers are having as much fun as the audience.

2. Pinpointing oddball conditions and rare afflictions with razor-sharp acuity after lesser doctors have tried and failed to come up with the right illness, House and his team have to cut through physiological red herrings and psychological obstruction to figure out what is ailing the hapless victim of the moment.

3. If Sherlock Holmes came back as a doctor, he might look like Dr Gregory House, the brilliant but flawed diagnostician in the medical drama, House.

4. It is this perfect blend of two of the modern world's most deep-seated fascinations – the mystery story, and the gloriously varied dysfunctions of our own bodies – that has made House the most watched show on TV.

Q23. DIRECTIONS *for questions 22 and 23:* The sentences given in the question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a number. Decide on the proper order for the four sentences and key in the sequence of four numbers as your answer, in the input box given below the question.

1. Still, this indifference counted for little to the many decisive innovations in the realm of north Indian classical music, as it did to modern literature and painting, mainly because of the subterranean patronage of the Indian middle class, and its investment – despite its privileging of the sciences – in the arts.
2. Add to this the microtonal explorations of Indian music and the incredible mathematical complexity of its approach to rhythm, and you have some idea of why the ordinary English ear (not to mention the Indian one) might have been baffled.
3. Typical, because the discrepancy between British scholarly interest in Indian classical heritage and colonial indifference to developments in the arts – literature, painting, classical and modern music - in modern India is symptomatic.
4. No classical tradition in music is easily comprehensible to the ear of the lay populace, let alone to outsiders.

Q24. DIRECTIONS *for question 24:* There is a sentence that is missing in the paragraph below. Look at the paragraph and decide in which blank (option 1, 2, 3, or 4) the following sentence would best fit.

Sentence: Moreover, we can observe the progressive formation of a global animal law, that is, of animal protection as an object of international law.

Paragraph: Today, the protection of animals – the basic idea that animals are due some form of normative protection – is a generally accepted moral and political imperative, and is solidifying globally as a legal concern. _____(1)_____ On the level of domestic law, most countries across the world have some sort of animal-protective provisions or statutes, and a small but growing number of states have constitutionalized animal-protective objectives. _____(2)_____. In Europe, there exists an additional layer of regional international and supranational animal protection law. In the European Union in particular, animal protection has quasi-constitutional status and is recognized as a legitimate objective in the public interest. _____(3)_____. Overall, the pervasiveness of international concern for animal welfare suggests that animal protection may be emerging as a general principle of law. _____(4)_____.

- ☐ a) Option 1
- ☐ b) Option 2
- ☐ c) Option 3
- ☐ d) Option 4